

What it costs to build a house in Nigeria in 2026

Lagos building costs per square metre and by house type, in naira, pounds and dollars, with the stage-by-stage split we use for payments. Figures verified 2026-10-02; currency at CBN official rate on 2026-10-02 (₦1,767 = £1, ₦1,329 = \$1). Building only: excludes land, approvals, external works and furniture.

1. Cost per square metre

Finish level	Naira per m ²	Pounds per m ²	Dollars per m ²	Typically includes
Basic finish	₦150,000–₦220,000	£85–£125	\$113–\$166	Local tiles, standard doors and fittings, PVC ceilings, emulsion paint.
Standard finish	₦220,000–₦330,000	£125–£187	\$166–\$248	Good porcelain tiles, POP ceilings, quality sanitary ware, aluminium windows.
Premium finish	₦330,000–₦450,000	£187–£255	\$248–\$339	Imported finishes, feature lighting, fitted kitchen and wardrobes, smart wiring. High-end Ikoyi/Banana Island builds can exceed ₦450,000/m ² .

2. Cost by house type

House type	Floor area	Basic (₦m)	Standard (₦m)	Premium (₦m)	Standard (£)	Standard (\$)
2-bedroom bungalow	~90 m ²	13.5–20	20–29.5	29.5–40.5	£11k–£17k	\$15k–\$22k
3-bedroom bungalow	~130 m ²	19.5–28.5	28.5–43	43–58.5	£16k–£24k	\$21k–\$32k
4-bedroom bungalow	~170 m ²	25.5–37.5	37.5–56	56–76.5	£21k–£32k	\$28k–\$42k
4-bedroom duplex	~280 m ²	42–61.5	61.5–92.5	92.5–126	£35k–£52k	\$46k–\$70k
5-bedroom duplex	~350 m ²	52.5–77	77–115.5	115.5–157.5	£44k–£65k	\$58k–\$87k

3. Where the money goes, stage by stage

We split payments the same way: you pay for one stage at a time, released only after an independent inspector signs off the previous one.

Stage	Share of build cost	What it covers
Design, approvals and site preparation	5–10%	Drawings, structural design, soil test, building permit, clearing and setting out.
Foundation	10–15%	Excavation, blinding, footings or raft, foundation walls, DPC. More on waterlogged or reclaimed land.

Stage	Share of build cost	What it covers
Frame and blockwork	20-30%	Columns, beams, blockwork, lintels; for a duplex also the first-floor slab and stairs.
Roofing	8-12%	Timber or steel trusses, covering (stone-coated or aluminium), fascia and gutters.
Services	10-15%	Electrical wiring and fittings, plumbing, septic or soakaway, water storage.
Finishing	30-40%	Plaster, screed, tiles, ceilings, paint, doors, windows, sanitary ware, kitchen.

4. Not included: budget for these too

- Land: from about ₦15m a plot in Ikorodu to over ₦1bn in Ikoyi.
- Approvals: Lagos building permit and related fees, set by size and location.
- External works (fence, gate, paving, borehole, septic tank, generator house): usually 10-20% extra.
- Furniture, appliances and solar/inverter systems.
- A contingency of 5-10% for price movements and choices during the build.

5. Five rules that protect your money

- ✓ Verify the land title through a lawyer before you pay for land.
- ✓ Contract with a registered company, not an individual.
- ✓ Get an itemised, open-book bill of quantities and compare it with market prices.
- ✓ Pay in stages, each released only after independent inspection.
- ✓ See the site for yourself: live camera, dated weekly reports and video walk-rounds.

Get a figure for your own plot

These ranges are for planning. Your real cost comes from a bill of quantities priced on your drawings and soil test. Book a free 20-minute consultation by video call or WhatsApp at a time that suits your time zone: artemisatelierltd.com/build-from-abroad · WhatsApp +234 803 350 2393.

Live versions of these figures, with today's exchange rate and current material prices: artemisatelierltd.com/guides/cost-of-building-a-house-in-nigeria. Sources: Build With Ease (May 2026), Prioni (June 2026), Nigeria Building Cost 2026, Artemis Atelier material price tracker.